Visual Studio Code (VS Code) Installation Guide

FIELD	DETAILS
Product	Visual Studio Code (VS Code)
Document Type	Installation Guide
OS/Platform	Windows
Version	1.109.5
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Introduction

Visual Studio Code (VS Code) is a code editor developed by Microsoft. This guide helps users to successfully download, install, verify, and uninstall it on Windows.

Who This Guide Is For

This guide is intended for:

- Software Developers and IT Support Teams looking to install VS Code on their Windows for the first time.
- Beginners with basic computer knowledge looking to install VS Code on their Windows.

System Requirements

Component	Minimum	Recommended
OS	Windows 10 (64-bit)	Windows 11 (64-bit)
RAM	4 GB	8 GB
Disk Space	850 MB	1 GB
Processor	ARM64 or x64	Quad-core or better
Internet	Required for setup	stable internet connections

> 💡 **Note:** Recommended specifications are based on general best practices. Official minimum requirements sourced from code.visualstudio.com/docs/supporting/requirements

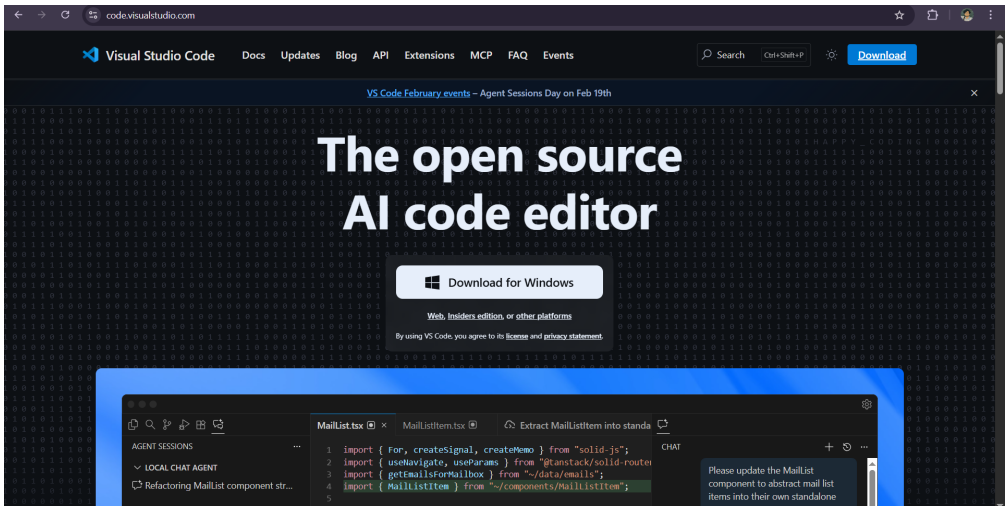
Prerequisites

- ☐ Administrator access
- ☐ Your system meets the minimum system requirements.
- ☐ Stable internet connection
- ☐ Any previous version of VS Code is uninstalled (for a clean installation)

Downloading VS Code

Step 1: Visit the official website of VS Code

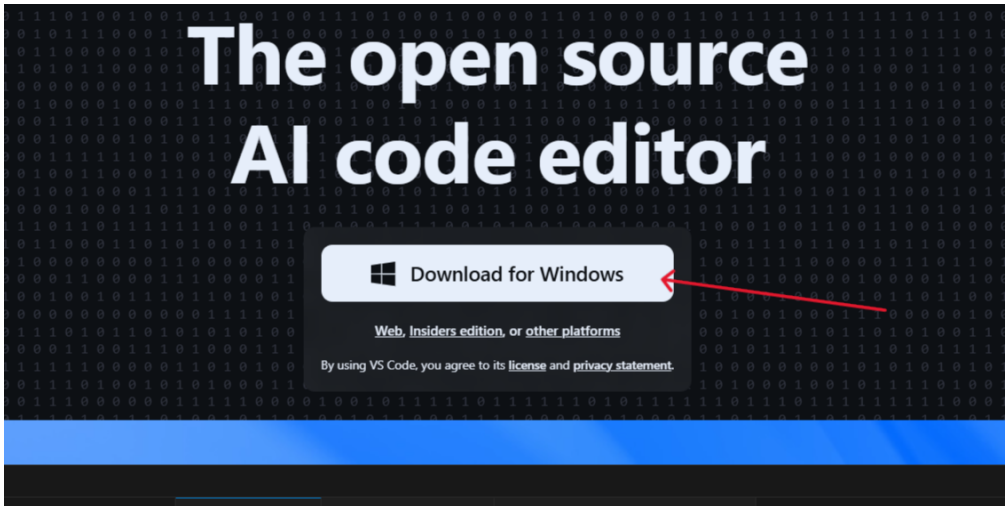
Go to the official website of VS Code: https://code.visualstudio.com/



> ⚠ **Warning:** Always download from the official website only. Avoid third-party download sites.

Step 2: Download the installer file for Windows

Click **Download for Windows**; wait for the download completion.



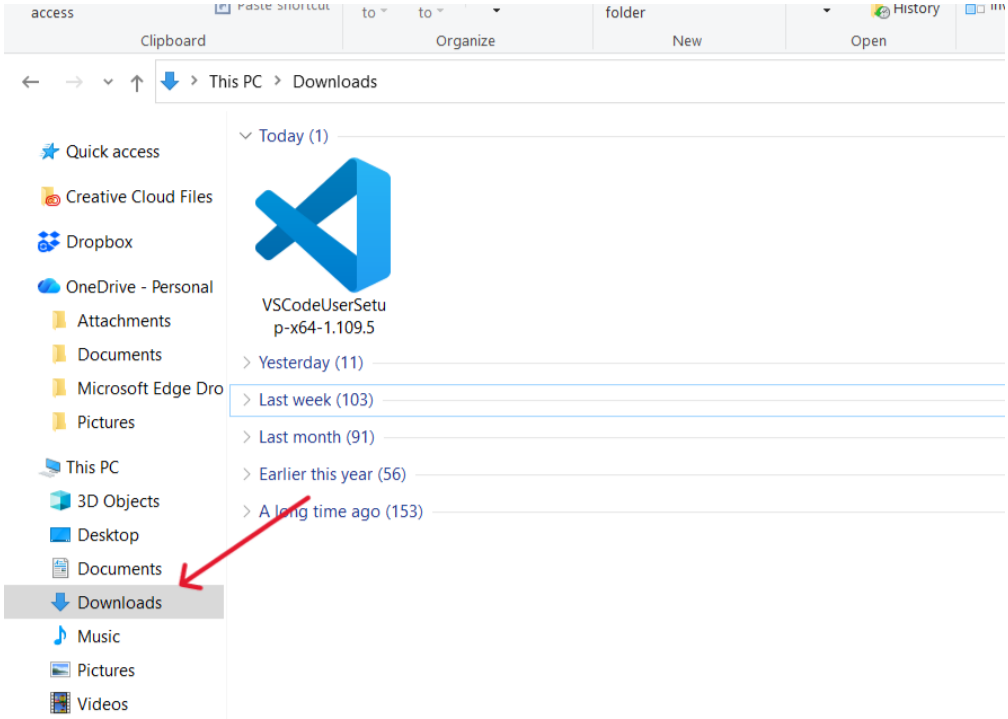
> 💡 **Tip:** Note where the file is downloaded - you will need it in the next step.

Expected Result: The installer file of VS Code is downloaded without any errors.

Installation Steps

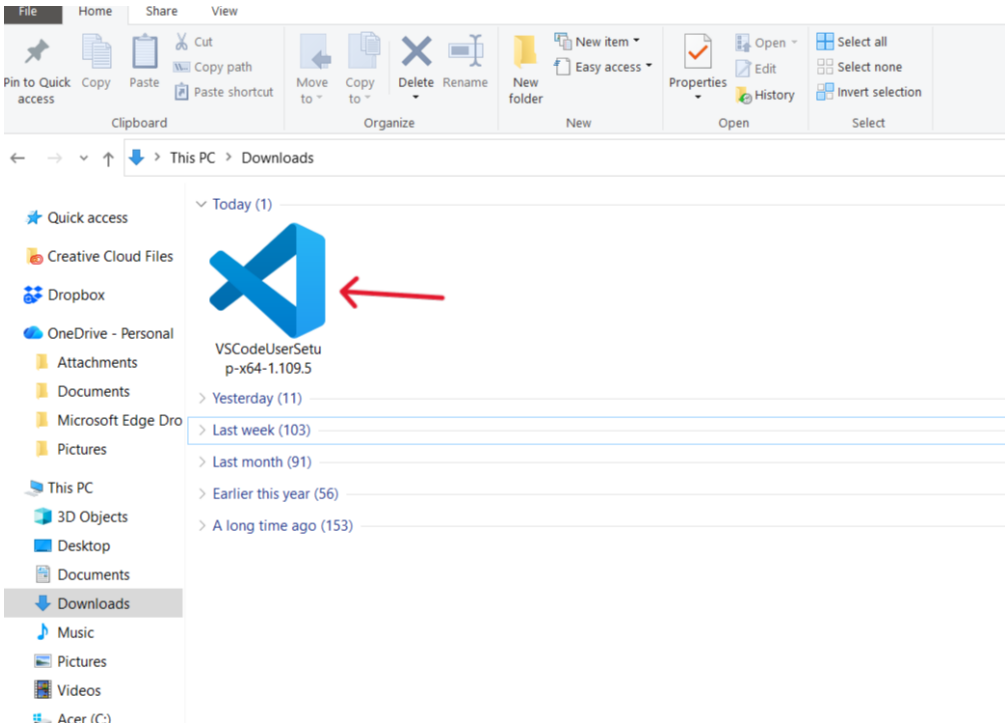
Step 1: Open the downloaded file location

Open the **Downloads folder** in your Windows.



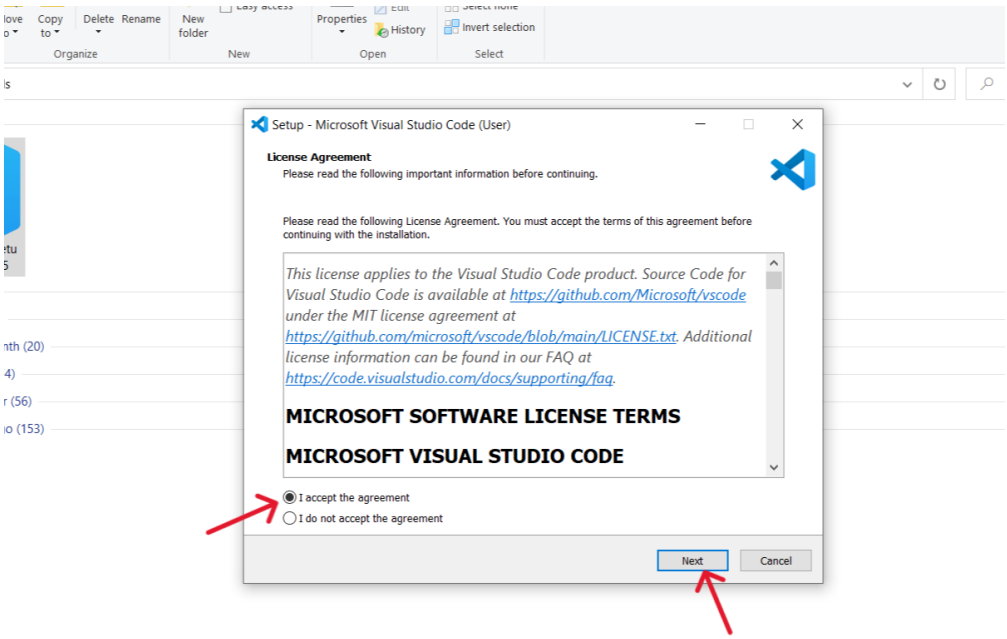
Step 2: Start the installation process

Double click `VSCodeUserSetup-x64-1.109.5`



Step 3: Accept the License Agreement

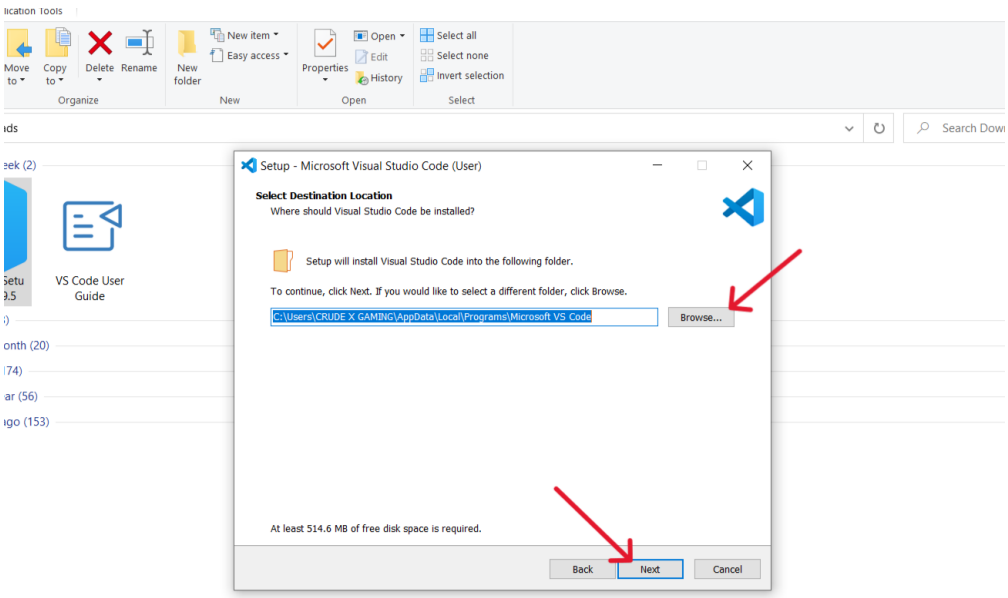
Click **I accept the agreement** after reading the License agreements > click **Next**.



> ⚠ **Warning:** You must accept the agreement to proceed with installation.

Step 4: Select the Installation Folder

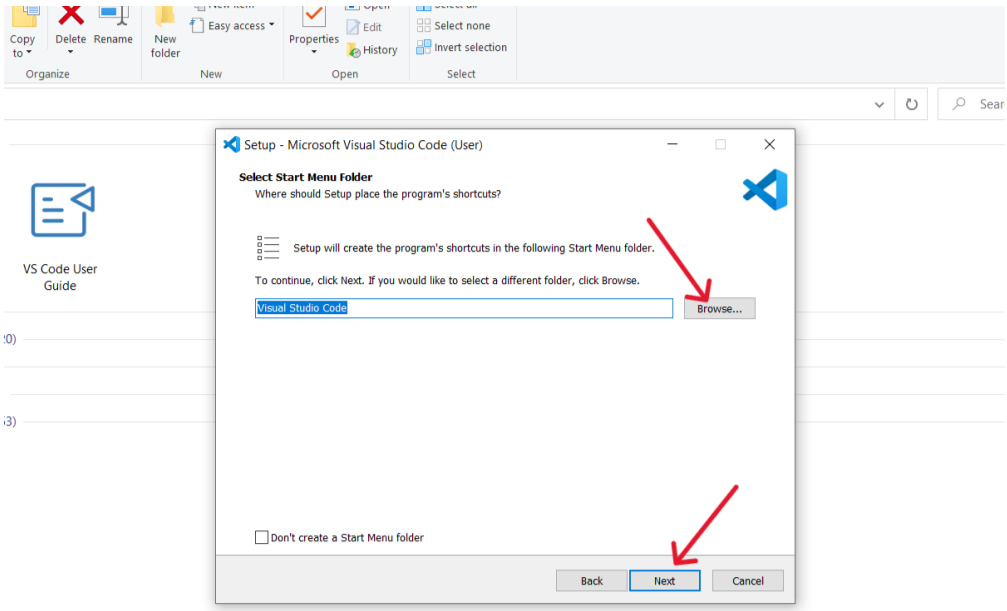
Select the folder to which you want the VS Code to be installed > **Next**.



> 💡 **Tip:** Keep the default folder unless you have a specific reason to change it.

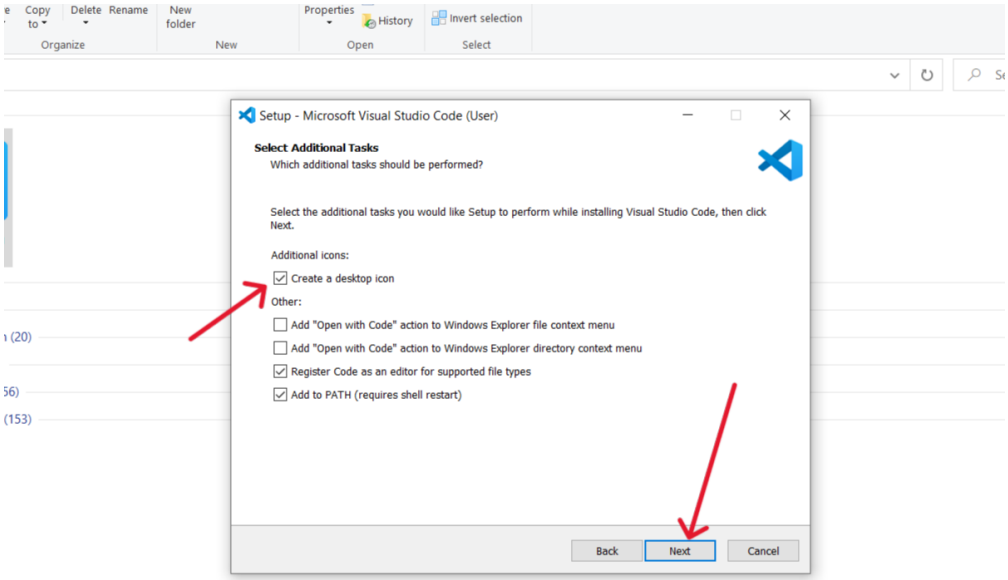
Step 5: Choose Menu Folder

Choose the **Start Menu Folder** > click **Next**



Step 6: Select Additional Task

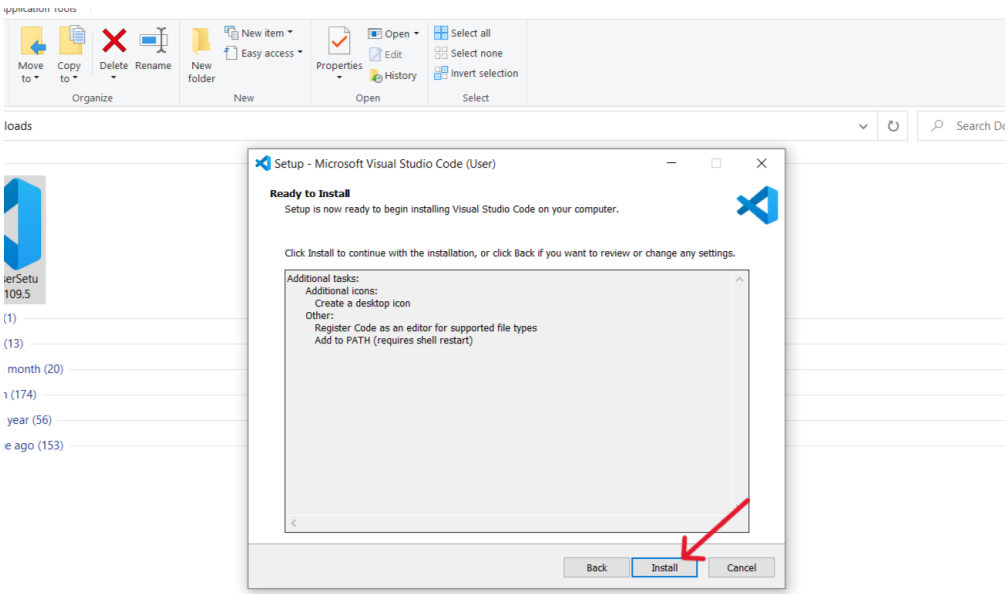
Tick the **Create a desktop icon** > **Next**.



> 💡 **Tip:** Also tick **Add to PATH** option — this allows you to open VS Code from the terminal directly.

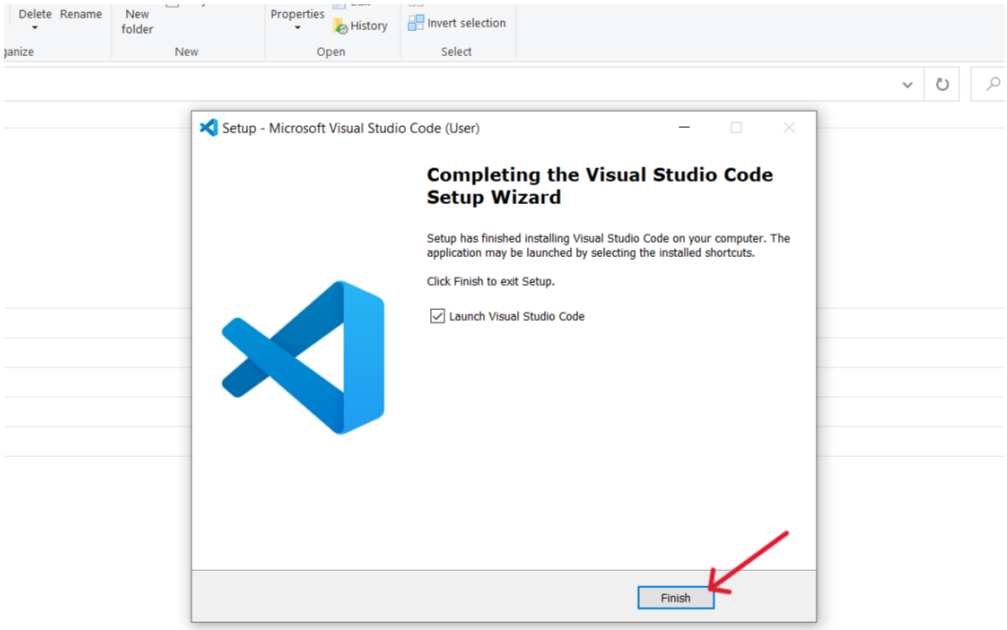
Step 7: Install

Click **Install** and wait for it to be completed.



Step 8: Complete the Installation

Click **Finish** to complete the installation. VS Code launches automatically.

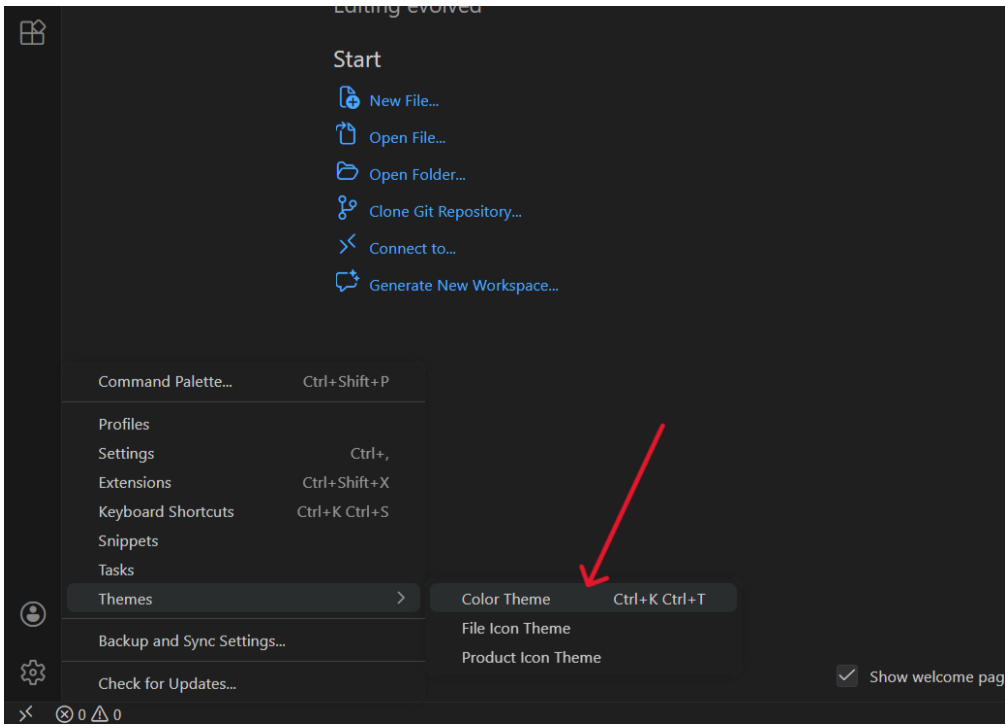


Expected Result: VS Code is installed on the system without any errors.

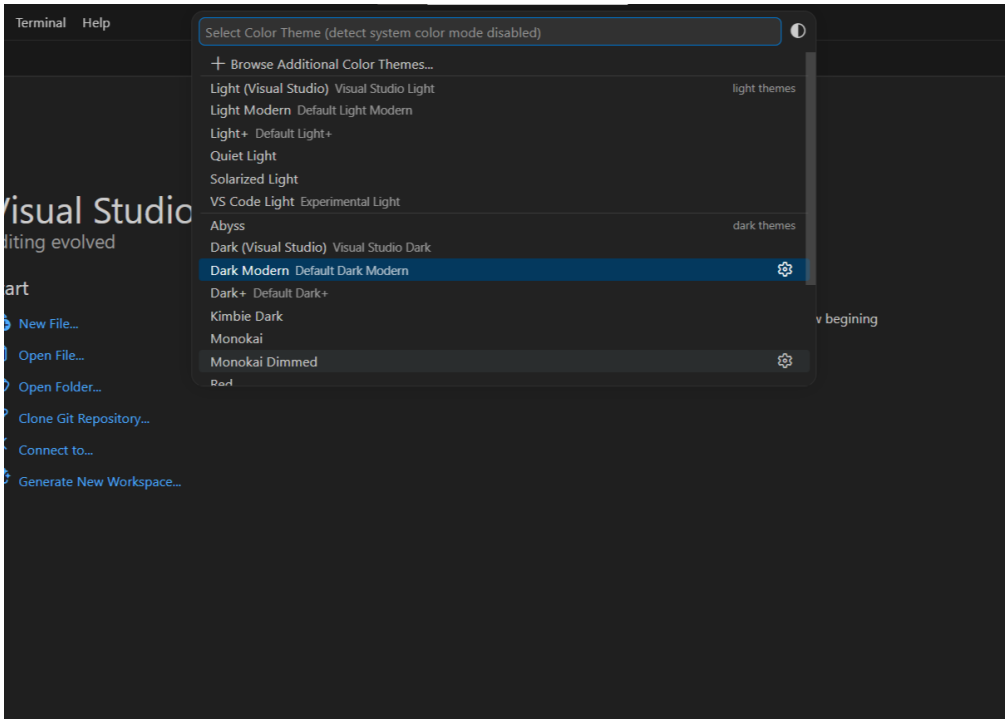
Post-Installation Setup

Step 1: Change the Color Theme

1. Click the **Setting Icon** on the left bottom > **Themes** > **Color Theme** (**Ctrl+K Ctrl+T**)



2. Select the theme you prefer from the given options.

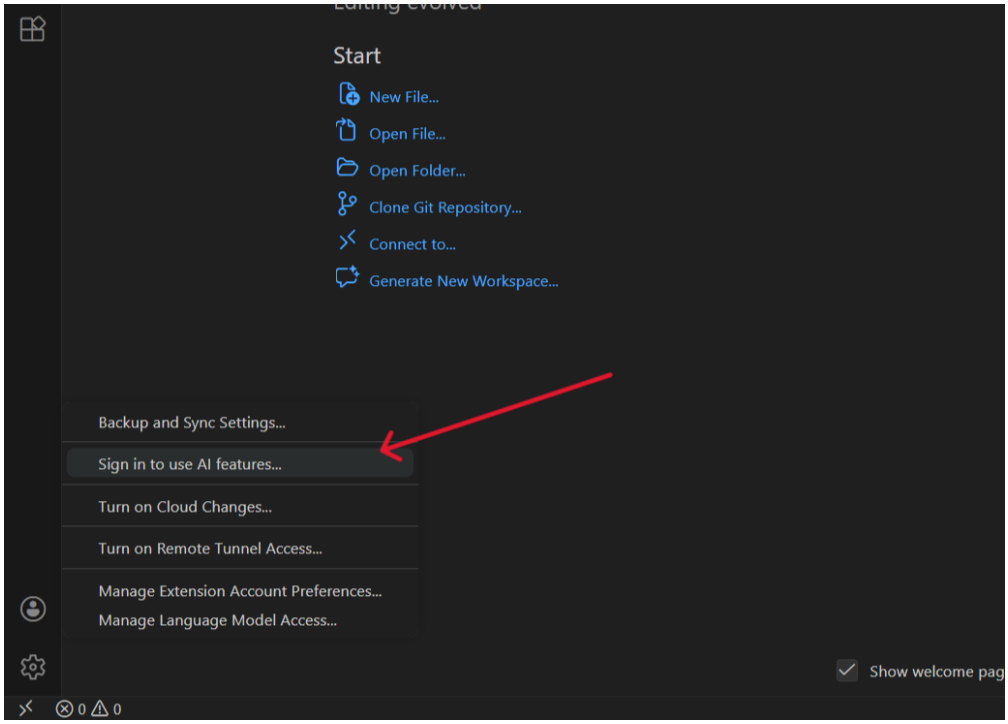


> 💡 **Tip:** Changing the color theme to dark is easier on the eyes during long coding sessions.

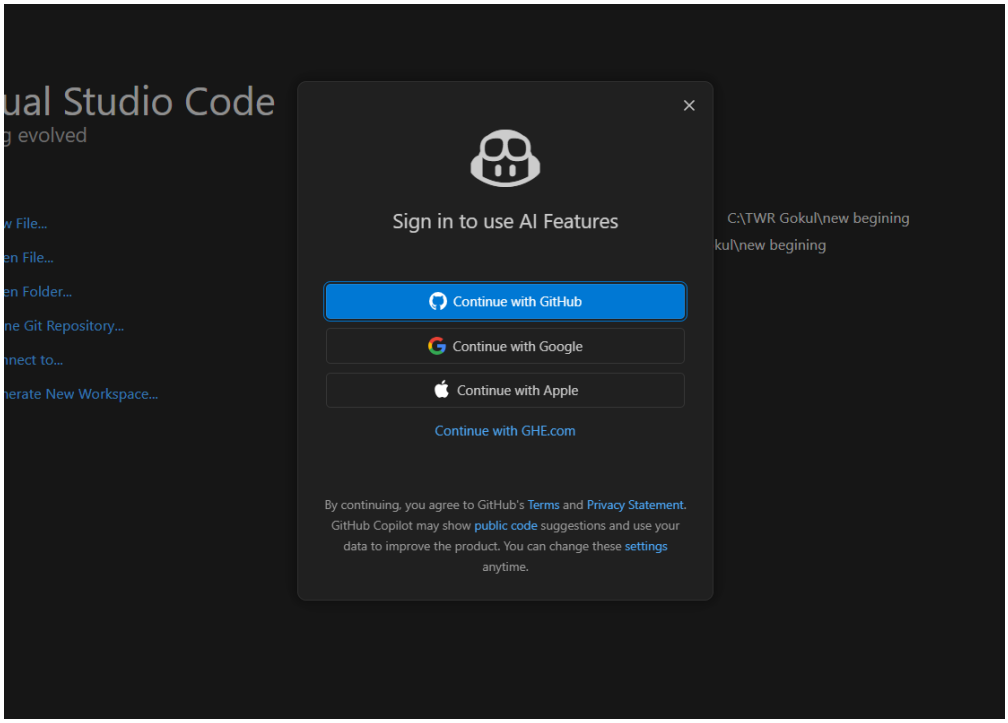
Expected Result: The color theme of VS Code is changed without any errors.

Step 2: Sign in to VS Code

1. Click on the **Profile icon** on the bottom left > **Sign in to use AI features**



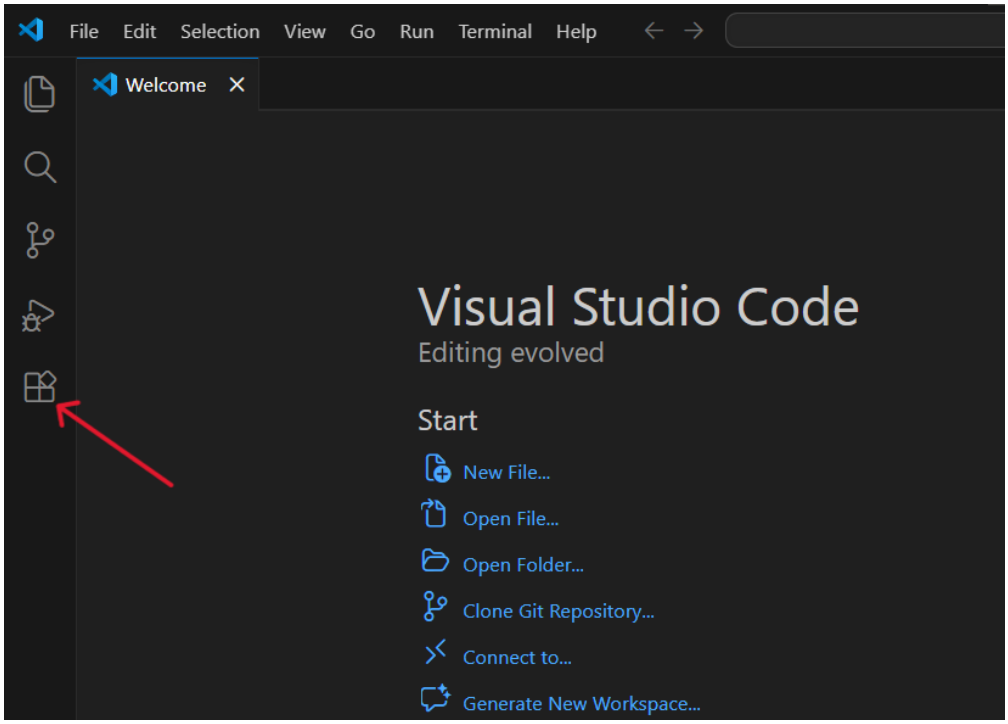
2. Choose a method to sign in; provide the credentials asked by the method you choose.



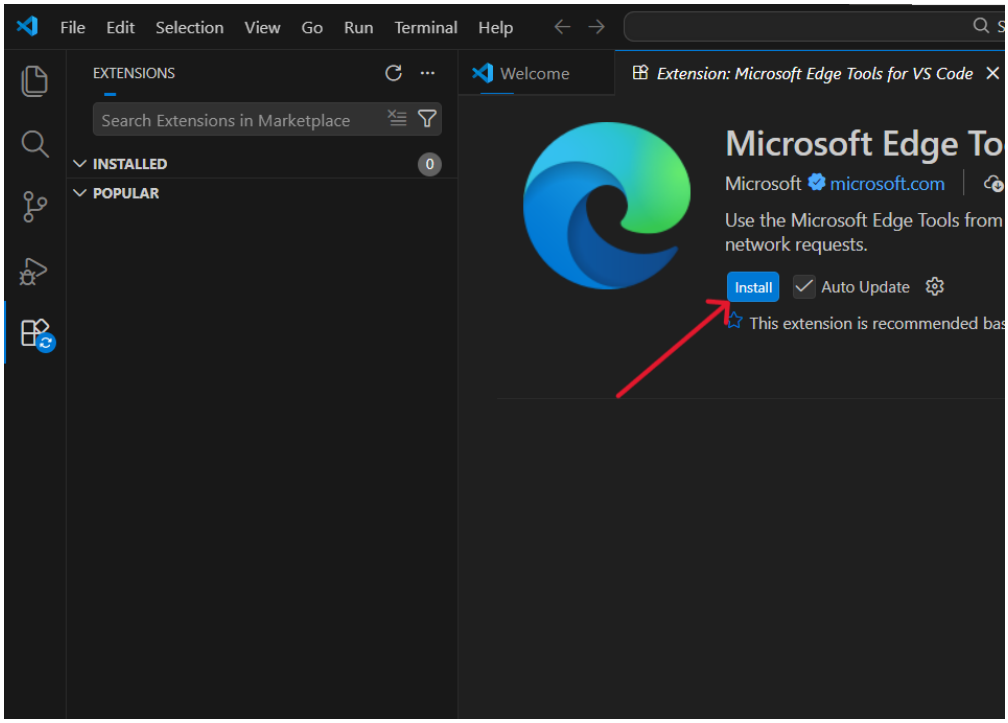
Expected Result: Successfully signed in to VS Code.

Step 3: Install Extensions

1. Click on the **Extension icon** (**Ctrl+Shift+X**) on the **Left side bar**.



2. Search for the extension you want > click **Install**



Expected Result: Extension is installed without any errors.

Verifying the Installation

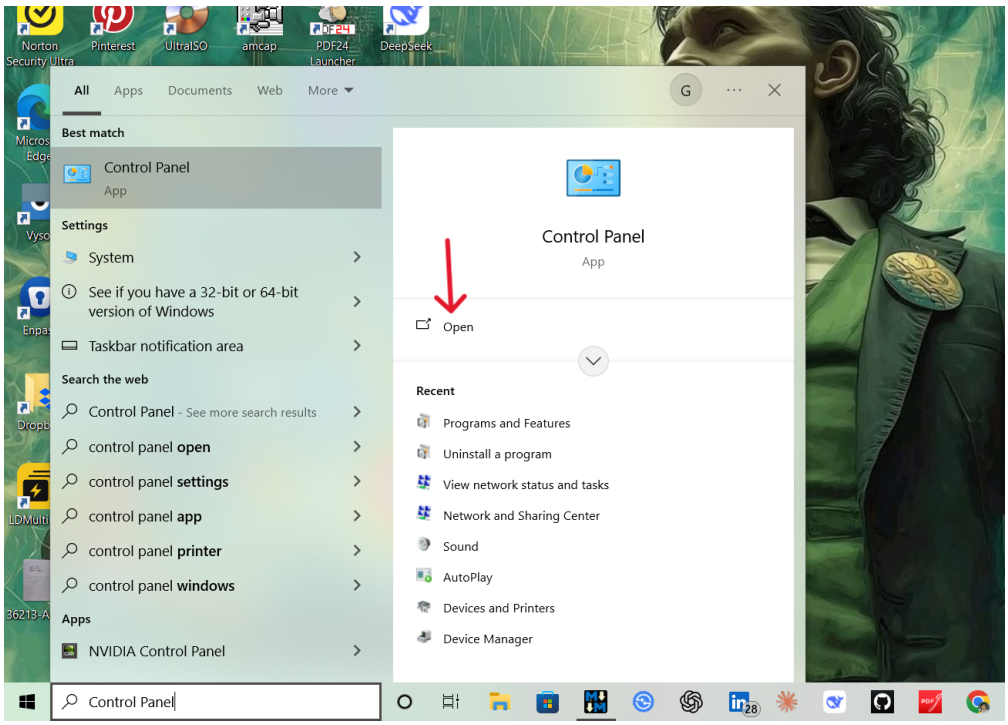
- ☐ Confirm VS Code opens without any errors.
- ☐ Verify the version is correct: Open VS Code > click **Help** > **About**.
- ☐ Ensure basic features like creating new files, extensions, terminals, and settings works properly.

Expected Result: VS Code is installed and functioning correctly on your Windows system.

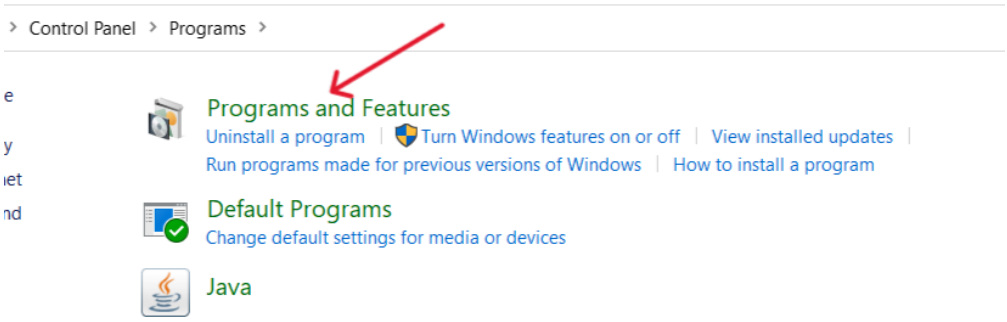
Uninstallation

Windows

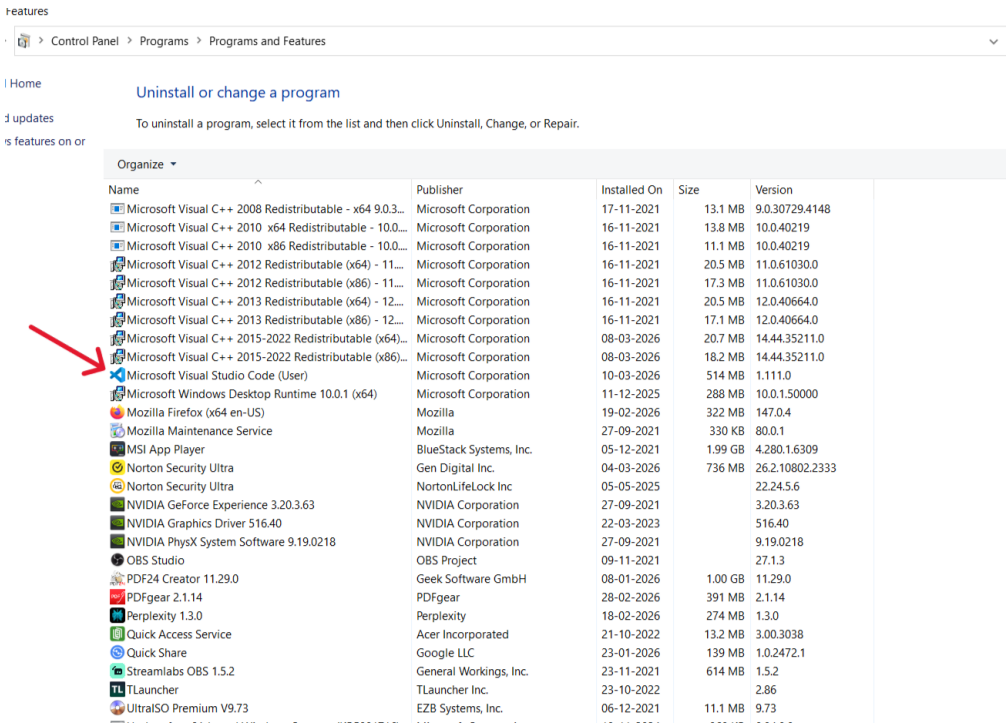
1. Open **Start menu** > search **Control Panel** > click **Open**



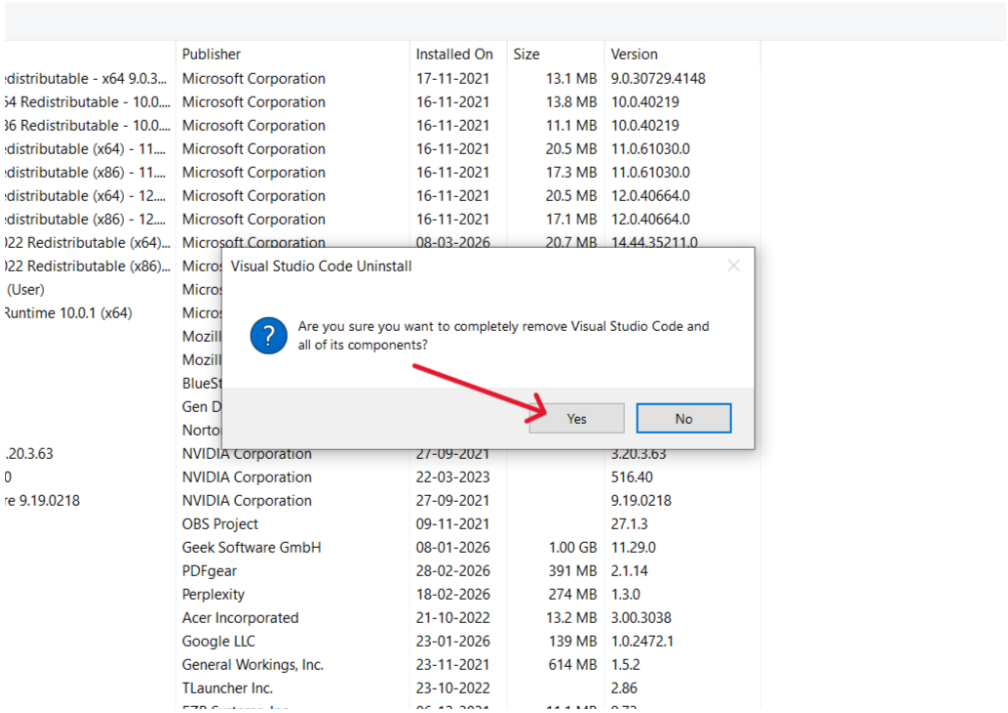
2. Click on **Programs** > **Programs and Features**



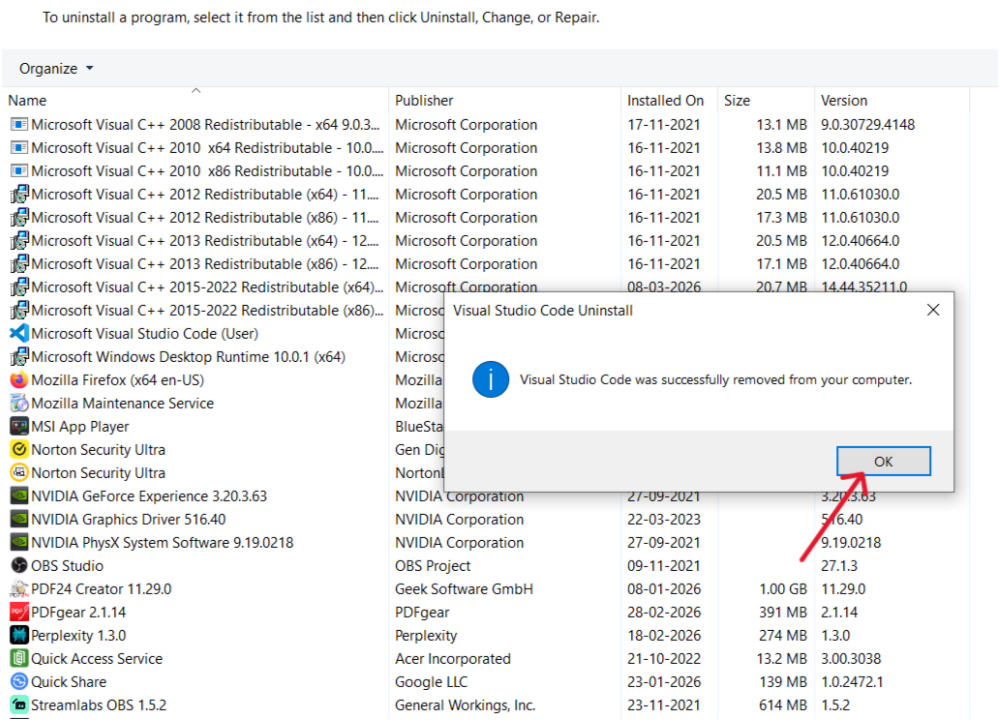
3. Search **Microsoft Visual Studio Code**



4. Click on the **VS Code app icon** > Choose **Yes** for the uninstall confirmation pop-up.



5. Wait for the uninstallation to get completed > Click **Ok** for the confirmation



Expected Result: VS Code is uninstalled from Windows without any errors.

Troubleshooting

Issue 1: Installing fails

Cause:

- Insufficient storage
- The system doesn't meet the minimum requirements for the installation
- Corrupted Installer file

Fix:

1. Ensure your system has enough storage for the installation. If not, delete some unwanted files.
2. Verify your system meets the minimum requirements listed in the System Requirements section above.
3. Confirm the installer file is of the latest version. If not, download the latest installer file from the official website.
4. Attempt the action again.

> ⚠ **Warning:** Do not interrupt the installation process once it has started.

Expected Result: VS Code is successfully installed on Windows.

Issue 2: Installing the extension fails

Cause:

- Unstable internet connection
- Insufficient storage space
- Permission for the extension is blocked in settings.
- The app is outdated for the extension.

Fix:

1. Ensure a stable internet connection.
2. Confirm your system has enough storage space for the installation. If not, delete some unwanted files.
3. Make sure the type of extension you are trying to install is allowed. To check that, click the **settings icon** > **Settings** > search **Extension** > confirm the type of extension is allowed.
4. Check whether the type of extension runs on your current app version. If not, update VS Code by clicking **Help** > **Check for Updates** and installing available updates.

Expected Result: The extension is successfully installed.

Issue 3: Unable to Uninstall

Cause:

- VS Code is still running in the background.
- Insufficient administrator permissions.

Fix:

1. Open **Task Manager** (**Ctrl+Shift+Esc**) and end any running VS Code processes
2. Ensure you have administrator access on Windows
3. Restart the system
4. Attempt the uninstallation again.

Expected Result: VS Code is successfully uninstalled from Windows.

FAQ

Q1: Is VS Code free?

A: Yes, VS Code is a free code editor, that runs on the macOS, Linux, and Windows operating systems.

Q2: How to update the app?

A: By default, VS Code automatically updates when new versions are released. To disable auto-updates, go to **File** > **Preferences** > **Settings** > search **Update: Mode** > change it from **default** to **none**.

Q3: Can I control which extensions are allowed to be installed?

A: Yes, by default, all extensions are allowed. You can set this to allow only specific ones. You can filter by publisher, extension, version, or platform. Then, block the others. To do this, go to **Settings** (**Ctrl+,**) > **Extension settings**; set it as you prefer.

Support & Contact

Channel	Details
Official Docs	https://code.visualstudio.com/docs
Community Forum	https://stackoverflow.com/questions/tagged/vscode
FAQ & Support	https://code.visualstudio.com/docs/supporting/FAQ

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All product information in this guide is based on VS Code Version 1.109.5 for Windows.

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